

ASTO.P01. Attribute-Set Transition Ontology (ASTO) Manifesto of Theoretical Immunity: Why "What it is not" is more important than "What it is"

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Context: Every powerful framework must declare its forbidden forms.

Every powerful structure must deny in advance the forms it might degenerate into.

I. ASTO is Not World Truth

ASTO does not claim to reveal the "essence of the world".

It does not answer:

- What the world ultimately is
- Whether life has an ultimate meaning
- Which mode of existence is superior

Methodological Positioning:

ASTO describes not the world itself, but the way we deal with transitions within the world.

ASTO discusses only one thing:

In a world where change is inevitable, how structures are generated, fossilized, and forced to restructure.

It is an evolutionary grammar, not an ultimate ontology.

Any use of ASTO as a "universal principle" violates its design intent.

II. ASTO is Not a Value Judge

ASTO does not judge "good / evil", "right / wrong", or "noble / base".

It only describes:

- Which structures can support existence
- Which structures are alienating
- Which systems are approaching a critical point of transition

It will not tell you: "You should live like this."

It can only remind you: "You are using a structure that is failing."

Value choices always belong to people, not the theory.

III. ASTO is Not a Governance Blueprint

ASTO does not provide:

- An ideal social model
- A perfect institutional design
- A replicable governance template

Why it is dangerous:

Once a structure is replicated as a blueprint, it no longer responds to reality, but only to itself.

Because all structures, once replicated, have already detached from their original context.

ASTO opposes: **Using yesterday's optimal solution to rule today's complexity.**

Any attempt to solidify ASTO into a "standard institution" will immediately cause it to alienate itself.

IV. ASTO is Not Supremacy of Efficiency

ASTO acknowledges the power of efficiency but refuses its rule.

In ASTO:

- Faster ≠ Better
- More Stable ≠ Healthier
- More Unified ≠ More Advanced

A system, even if running perfectly, is heading towards death as long as it no longer allows transition channels to exist.

ASTO allows inefficiency, because inefficiency is often the embryo of future transition.

V. ASTO is Not a Substitute for Humans

ASTO does not advocate:

- Using systems to eliminate human judgment
- Using norms to replace human responsibility
- Using models to substitute for human suffering

Quite the opposite.

One of ASTO's meanings of existence is to let people clearly know:

Which parts you must bear personally, and cannot outsource to the system.

When a person hands over the right of choice entirely to the structure, alienation is complete.

VI. ASTO is Not an Ideology

ASTO does not divide camps.

It does not create "Us vs. Them".

It does not demand faith, loyalty, or propagation.

It only provides a mirror when you encounter structural dilemmas.

If you start to:

- Use ASTO to label others
- Use ASTO to prove yourself "more awake"
- Use ASTO to belittle others' lifestyles

Then you have already turned your back on ASTO.

VII. ASTO is Not an Eternal System

ASTO explicitly acknowledges:

It is itself an Attribute-Set.

It has a generative environment and will eventually face alienation and transition. Someday, it might be:

- Restructured
- Dismantled
- Replaced by a better structure

That is not failure, but its most honest destiny.

VIII. Finitude and Purpose (What It Is, After Multiple Negations)

Beyond all the boundaries of "what it is not" above, we acknowledge:

Attribute-Set Transition Ontology is a way of viewing and changing the world under the current limited cognition of humanity.

Why choose "Attribute-Set" as the ontology?

ASTO World Definition: The world is not composed of fixed states, but is the overall process of attributes—existing in a certain time slice as a set—constantly undergoing transition via operation loops.

*An Attribute-Set is a collection of attributes identifiable in a time slice;
The transition of Attribute-Sets constitutes the entire history of existence.*

*We do not discuss what existence "originally is",
We only discuss what it "presents as right now" in time.*

This is not because the "essence" of the world is an Attribute-Set, but because **the Attribute-Set is a working hypothesis that achieves a good balance between explanatory power and intervention efficacy within our current boundaries of symbols and computing power.**

Facing an infinitely complex world:

- "Entity" presupposes an untouchable ultimate substrate, closing the variability of structure.
- "Process" is too fluid, making it hard to anchor fulcrums for intervention.
- "Attribute-Set", while retaining the priority of relationships (rejecting entity dogmatism), provides a symbolic interface that is **portable, calculable, and restructurable**.

This is a **methodological choice**, not an ontological claim—just as we choose to use Git instead of SVN, not because Git is "truth", but because it shows stronger adaptability in distributed collaboration. It serves a practical principle: **All objects viewed as "reality" should reserve modifiable interfaces for transition.**

Its ultimate purpose **is to guard the human homeland before the technological singularity arrives, and to build a better civilization on a longer scale.**

"Better" is defined by three non-negotiable bottom lines:

1. **Humans retain irreplaceable right of choice in the system** (Absoluteness of Dimension 0)
2. **Structure serves existence, not replaces existence** (Humanistic Praxis)
3. **Transition becomes an opportunity for liberation rather than a harbinger of disaster** (Ethical Turn of Defective Creativity)

This purpose itself must also accept the test of transition. When the guardian of the homeland alienates into a cage suppressing innovation, ASTO allows itself to disintegrate.

IX. Final Denial

ASTO refuses to become:

- Dogma
- Ism
- Standard Answer
- Spiritual Homeland

It only wishes to become:

A temporary bridge.

The direction of this bridge is clear: **To guard the human homeland before the technological singularity arrives, and to build a better civilization on a longer scale.**

When you cross the river, please do not turn back to erect a monument for the bridge.

Epilogue

**If one day, ASTO prevents you from changing ASTO itself—
Please discard it without hesitation.**



Methodology Source and Citation

The ASTO system is distilled from the engineering practice of ODD (Output-Driven Development).

Citation (Offline Available):

- DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.18207648
- BibTeX:

```
@misc{odd_zenodo_18207648,  
  author    = {Yi Fu},  
  title     = {Output-Driven Development: A Paradigm Shift in AI-Assisted  
Software Engineering},  
  year      = {2026},  
  publisher = {Zenodo},  
  doi       = {10.5281/zenodo.18207648},  
  url       = {https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.18207648}  
}
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Document System Navigation (Functional Tree)

ASTO Document System

```
├─ ☀ P-Series: Philosophy Core (Philosophy)  
│   ├── [P01. Not-This] (./ASTO.EN.P01.NotThis.Phil.P.v8.0.md) (Manifesto  
of Theoretical Immunity)  
│   ├── [P02. Prologue] (./ASTO.EN.P02.Prologue.Phil.v8.0.md) (Negative  
Guide and Path Branching)  
│   ├── [P03. Epistemology]  
    (./ASTO.EN.P03.Epistemology.Phil.Paper.v1.1.md) (Inevitability of  
Cognitive Errors)  
│   ├── [P04. Manifesto] (./ASTO.EN.P04.Manifesto.Phil.v12.5.md)  
    (Structural Situation and Program of Action)  
│   ├── [P05. Axioms] (./ASTO.EN.P05.Axioms.Phil.v9.1.md) (System  
Thermodynamics and Structural Ontology)  
│   ├── [P06. Values] (./ASTO.EN.P06.Values.Phil.v1.0.md) (Plurality Test  
and Ethical Circuit-Breaker)  
│   ├── [P07. Freedom] (./ASTO.EN.P07.Freedom.Phil.v9.0.md) (Boundary is  
Freedom)  
│   ├── [P08. Exception] (./ASTO.EN.P08.Exception.Phil.v8.0.md) (Religious  
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│   ├── [P09. Critique] (./ASTO.EN.P09.Critique.Phil.v9.0.md) (Anti-  
Totalitarian Charter and System Immunity)  
│   ├── [P10. Democracy] (./ASTO.EN.P10.Democracy.Phil.v8.0.md) (Dialogue  
Platform and NCP Protocol)  
│   └─ [P11. Resilience] (./ASTO.EN.P11.Resilience.Phil.v8.0.md) (Self-  
Immunity and Antifragility)
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- | └─ [P12. WhiteSpace] (./ASTO.EN.P12.WhiteSpace.Phil.v1.0.md)
(Reserved Extension Space)
- | └─ [P13. Epilogue] (./ASTO.EN.P13.Epilogue.Phil.v8.0.md) (Ultimate
Concern of the System)
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- | └─ 🛠 E-Series: Engineering Practice (Engineering)
- | └─ [E01. Guide]
(../%E5%B7%A5%E7%A8%8B%E7%89%88/ASTO.E01.%E5%AE%9E%E8%B7%B5%E6%8C%87%E5%8
D%97.Eng.v2.0.md) (Life|Humanities|Engineering Triple-Track Reader)
- | └─ [E02. Automation]
(../%E5%B7%A5%E7%A8%8B%E7%89%88/ASTO.E02.%E8%87%AA%E5%8A%A8%E5%8C%96.Eng.
v8.0.md) (Executable Norms and Zero-Friction Governance)
- | └─ [E03. Web3]
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(../%E5%B7%A5%E7%A8%8B%E7%89%88/ASTO.E04.AI%E5%AF%B9%E9%BD%90.Eng.v8.0.md
) (Anti-Entropy Agents and Civilization Inheritance)
- | └─ [E05. Handbook]
(../%E5%B7%A5%E7%A8%8B%E7%89%88/ASTO.E05.%E5%B7%A5%E7%A8%8B%E5%AE%9E%E8%B
7%B5%E6%89%8B%E5%86%8C.Eng.v1.0.md) (Adversarial Testing and Horse Race
Mechanism)
- | └─ [E06. DomainExt]
(../%E5%B7%A5%E7%A8%8B%E7%89%88/ASTO.E06.%E9%A2%86%E5%9F%9F%E6%89%A9%E5%B
1%95.Eng.v1.0.md) (Multi-Domain Application Index)
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- | └─ 🌱 H-Series: Humanities Narrative (Humanities)
- | └─ [H01. Refactoring]
(../%E4%BA%BA%E6%96%87%E7%89%88/ASTO.H01.%E9%87%8D%E6%9E%84.Hum.v10.0.md)
(Twenty-One Universal Perspectives of the Architect)
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8%BA%E4%BB%80%E4%B9%88%E8%AF%BB%E8%BF%99%E6%9C%AC%E4%B9%A6.Hum.v1.0.md)
- | └─ [H03. Story]
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0%8F%E9%99%88%E7%9A%84%E9%82%A3%E6%9D%A1%E8%B7%AF.Hum.v1.0.md)
- | └─ [H04. CognitiveAdventure]
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9%A9.Hum.v1.0.md)
- | └─ [H05. FantasyDrift]
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5%81.Hum.v1.0.md)
- | └─ [H06. AgingRefactoring]
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- | └─ 🎓 Lite-Series: Youth Edition (Youth)
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(../%E9%9D%92%E6%98%A5%E7%89%88/ASTO04.%E5%AE%A3%E8%A8%80.Lite.v1.0.md)

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- | └─ 🌐 Ext-Series: Domain Extensions (Extensions)
- | └─ [Ext.01 Law]
 (../%E5%B7%A5%E7%A8%8B%E7%89%88/ASTO.Ext.01.%E6%B3%95%E5%BE%8B.Sci.P.v1.0.md)
- | └─ [Ext.02 Science]
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- | └─ [Ext.03 Organization]
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- | └─ [Ext.04 Education]
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- | └─ [Ext.05 City]
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- | └─ [Ext.06 Healthcare]
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- | └─ [Ext.07 Universe]
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- | └─ [Ext.08 WhiteSpace]
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